

Hydraulic Engineering - Staff Meeting

13-



Dutch Language Pilot
HE & 3MD

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2. Background
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Agenda



Background

- **A changing staff composition**

The number of international academic staff is growing, while Dutch-speaking staff will reduce due to retirements.

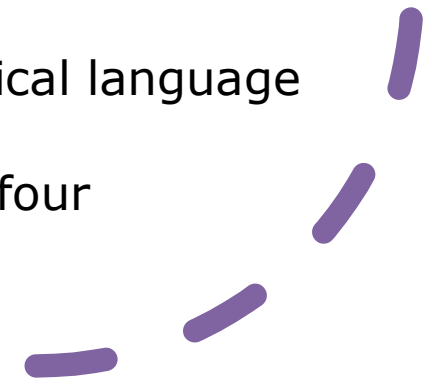
- **The importance of Dutch language proficiency**

Dutch proficiency supports teaching, collaboration with Dutch-speaking stakeholders and funding partners, participation in university management roles, and integration into Dutch society.

- **Current options within TU Delft**

Group-based courses focused on practical language use (ITAV)

Small-scale courses on request (up to four participants, not offered online)



Set-up and target group

- **Learning format**
One-to-one online lessons, organised in 12-lesson cycles and tailored to the participant's level and availability.
- **Expected workload**
Approximately 1 hour of instruction and 3 hours of independent study per week.
- **Learning objective**
Structured progression towards at least B2 level, with the possibility to continue towards C1 where relevant.
- **Target group**
Academic staff members with permanent contracts in HE and 3MD.
- **Pilot duration**
Two-year pilot, with the possibility of extension depending on evaluation outcomes.



Dutch, English & Chinese Language Training



- Founded in 2001
- 50 teachers, 1500 students per year
- Structured & communicative approach
- KickstartNet - Online learning platform
- 9.5 - 6408 verified reviews in 11 years
- Private and small group courses
- F2F & Remote classes



Programme structure

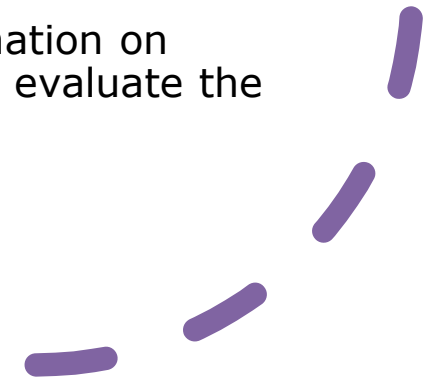
- **Start from your assessed level**
Your learning path is based on your current Dutch level.
- **12 one-to-one lessons per cycle**
Lessons are planned between you and your teacher.
- **Progress review after each cycle**
A short progress update helps determine the next step.
- **Assessment when ready**
After completing a study book, you take a written and oral assessment and may receive a certificate.

Complimentary activities

- **Dutch Grammar Bootcamp**
A face-to-face workshop for participants who would benefit from additional support with key grammar structures, such as word order, tenses, *er* and *zou(den)*.
- **Conversation Cafés**
Teacher-led small-group sessions focused on active speaking practice, with attention to everyday communication and, at higher levels, work-related interaction.
- **Purpose**
These activities complement the one-to-one lessons and provide additional opportunities to practise Dutch in a more interactive setting.

Commitment and responsibilities

- **Active participation**
Participants are expected to attend lessons consistently and actively engage with the lessons.
- **Time investment**
The expected workload is approximately 1 hour of instruction and 3 hours of independent study per week.
- **Preparation and self-study**
Progress depends not only on the lessons, but also on regular preparation, homework and independent practice.
- **Learning agreement**
Participants will be asked to sign a learning agreement outlining the expectations regarding participation, workload and progression.
- **Evaluation of the pilot**
Participants agree that anonymised information on participation and progress may be used to evaluate the pilot.

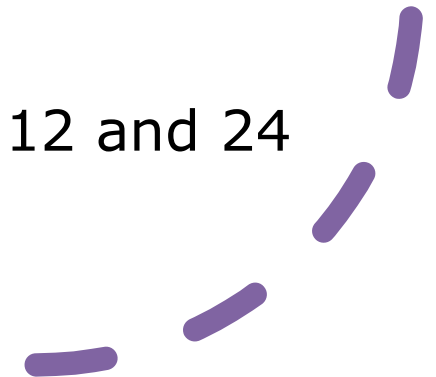


Evaluation and progress monitoring

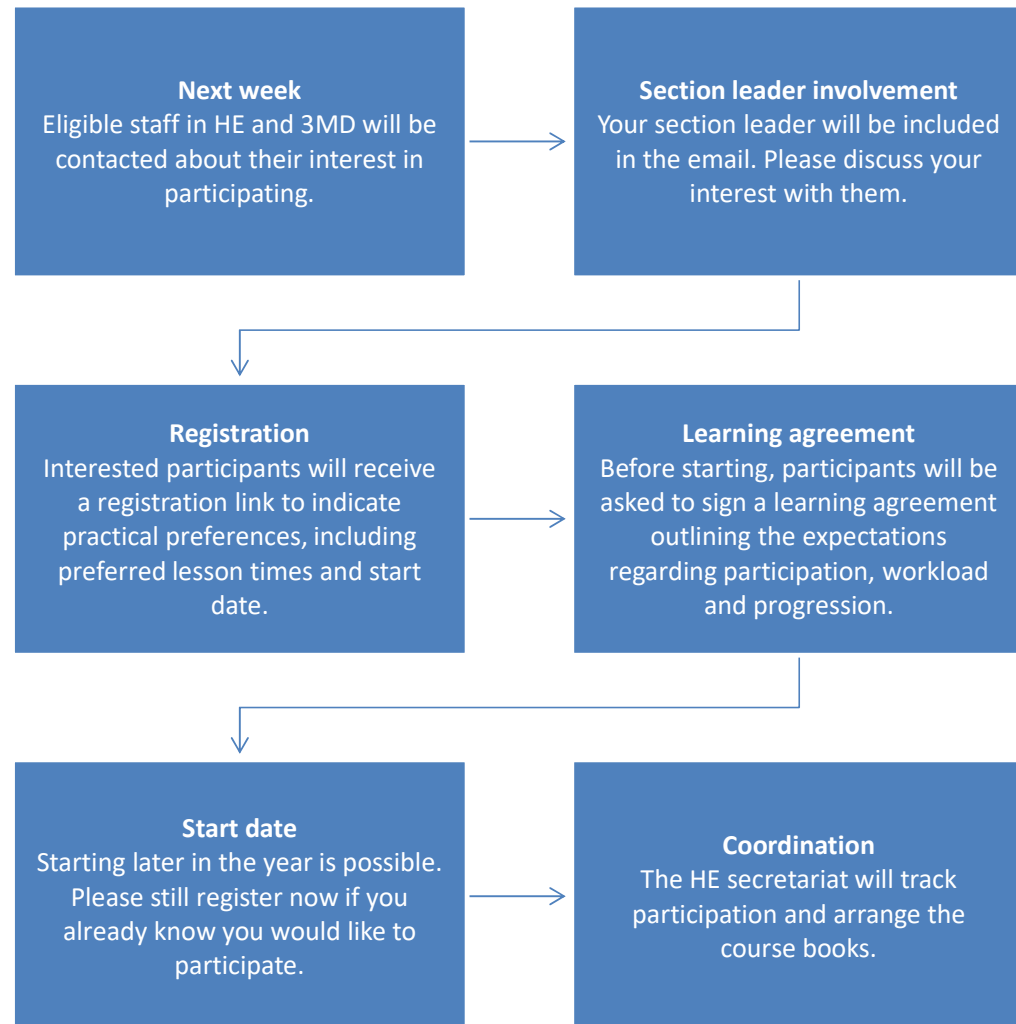
The pilot will be evaluated on:

- progress from the initial Dutch level;
- participant satisfaction and experienced workload;
- fit with academic schedules and working patterns;
- use of Dutch in relevant professional contexts;
- overall effectiveness of the one-to-one approach.

Evaluation moments: after 6, 12 and 24 months.



Practical next steps





Any questions?